

ascent stage would go back to rendezvous and dock into the CSM of the Apollo 11.

The descent stage comprised the lower part of the spacecraft and was an octagonal prism 4.2 metres across and 1.7 metres thick. It served as a platform for launching the ascent stage and was left behind on the Moon.

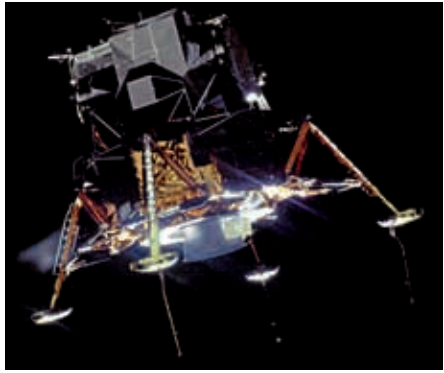
The unit contained the landing rocket, two tanks of aerazine 50 fuel, two

tanks of nitrogen tetroxide oxidizer, water, oxygen and helium tanks and storage space for the lunar equipment and experiments. The engine was a deep-throttling ablative rocket with a maximum thrust of about 45,000 N mounted on a gimbal ring in the center of the descent stage.

Four landing legs with round footpads were mounted on the sides, which held the bottom of the stage about 1.5 metres above the surface. One of the legs had a small astronaut egress platform and ladder. A one-metre long conical descent engine skirt protruded from the bottom of the stage. The descent stage dry mass was 2034 kg and 8212 kg of propellant were onboard initially.

The ascent stage was an irregularly shaped unit approximately 2.8 m high and 4.0 by 4.3 meters in width mounted on top of the descent stage. It was launched from the Moon at the end of lunar surface operations and returned the astronauts to the CSM.

The ascent stage housed the astronauts in a pressurized crew compartment with a volume of 6.65 cubic meters which functioned as the base of operations for lunar operations. There was an ingress-egress hatch in one side and a docking hatch for connecting to the CSM on top, next to a radar antenna for the rendezvous. Two triangular windows were above and to either side of the egress hatch and four thrust chamber assemblies were mounted around the sides. An environmental control system recycled oxygen and maintained temperature in the electronics and cabin. There were no seats in the LM. A control console was mounted in the front of the



The Apollo 11 Lunar Module Eagle, in a landing configuration, photographed from the CSM by astronaut Michael Collins